TOVA-STER

FREE GUIDE

Your UK winter vitamin plan

What the NHS suggests, who needs it most, and a simple daily routine.

Why winter matters

From about late March or early April to the end of September, most people in the UK can make the vitamin D they need from sunlight on their skin. Between October and early March the sun is too low, and **we do not make enough vitamin D from sunlight**.

The NHS advice in one line

Everyone, including pregnant and breastfeeding women, should consider taking a **daily supplement containing 10 micrograms (400 IU) of vitamin D** during the autumn and winter.

Who should consider it all year round

The NHS suggests adults and children over 4 take 10 micrograms of vitamin D every day, all year, if they:

- are not often outdoors, for example frail or housebound people
- live in a care home
- usually wear clothes that cover most of their skin when outdoors

People with dark skin, for example from an African, African-Caribbean or South Asian background, may also not make enough vitamin D from sunlight and should consider a daily supplement all year.

Babies and young children

- Babies from birth to 1 year: a daily supplement of 8.5 to 10 micrograms all year if breastfed, or if having less than 500ml of infant formula a day (formula is already fortified).
- Children aged 1 to 4: a daily supplement of 10 micrograms all year.

How much is too much

Who	Do not take more than
Adults (including pregnant and breastfeeding women) and children aged 11 to 17	100 micrograms (4,000 IU) a day
Children aged 1 to 10	50 micrograms (2,000 IU) a day
Babies under 12 months	25 micrograms (1,000 IU) a day

Some medical conditions mean people cannot safely take as much. If in doubt, speak to your GP or pharmacist.

Vitamin D from food

Food alone rarely gives enough in winter, but it helps. Good sources include oily fish such as salmon, sardines, herring and mackerel; red meat; egg yolks; and fortified foods such as some fat spreads and breakfast cereals. Liver also contains vitamin D, but pregnant women should avoid it. In the UK, cows' milk is generally not a good source because it is not fortified.

A routine you'll actually keep

- **Pair it with breakfast.** Vitamin D is fat-soluble, so taking it with a meal is an easy habit to anchor.
- **Keep the pot where you'll see it,** next to the kettle or your toothbrush (and out of children's reach).
- **Set a daily phone reminder** for the first two weeks, until it sticks.
- **Don't double up.** Check the label of any multivitamin you already take, so your total stays within the limits on page 1.
- **Never run out in January.** A Subscribe & Save order sends the next pot before you finish this one.

Other everyday nutrients

- **Iron** contributes to the reduction of tiredness and fatigue and to normal formation of red blood cells and haemoglobin.
- **Vitamin C** increases iron absorption and contributes to the normal function of the immune system.
- **Zinc** contributes to the normal function of the immune system.
- **Biotin and selenium** contribute to the maintenance of normal hair.

From the Tova-Ster range

Vitamin D3 4000iu: a high-strength, once-a-day tablet at the maximum daily amount the NHS gives for adults. It is **not for children**; for children, look at our **Multivitamin and Mineral for Children** berry gummies instead.

Iron & Vitamin C berry gummies and **Collagen Complex** orange gummies round out a simple winter routine.

Shop at **tova-ster.com**. Free UK delivery over £40.

Food supplements should not be used as a substitute for a varied, balanced diet and a healthy lifestyle. Do not exceed the recommended daily dose. If you are pregnant, breastfeeding, taking medication or have a medical condition, speak to your GP or pharmacist before taking a supplement. Keep out of sight and reach of young children.

Source: NHS, "Vitamin D" (nhs.uk/conditions/vitamins-and-minerals/vitamin-d), checked October 2026. This guide is general information and is not medical advice.